

PREPARED FOR

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Welcome to Food Jazz!

The curriculum is going to bend around what you actually want to cook. Every meal you make this month is something I'll see and respond to. In your case that means high-protein, low-carb meals you can pull together without thinking about them.

Cooking has been the most steady thing in my life through some unsteady years. I spent close to a decade running Foodnome, and the kitchen was where I'd go when payroll was tight, when we were pivoting the whole business through the pandemic, when nothing else felt steady. An hour at the stove and I'd have at least one thing that came out right. I want you to have that.

The rest of this packet covers what Food Jazz actually is, what the next thirty days look like, and how to show up. Give it a good read. Underline whatever you push back on. Bring those to our first session.

After our audit, the first week is observation. Eat the way you normally eat — don't do anything extra. Send me photos when you can. That helps me build the month around what you actually like, instead of guessing.

Can't wait to cook with you,



AKSHAY PRABHU

What Food Jazz *actually* is.

Food Jazz is a way of cooking that starts with what you already know. You've been eating your whole life. You have strong opinions. You can walk into a restaurant and tell within three bites whether the chef is paying attention. You have taste. What's missing is a way to translate what's in your head onto your plate. That's what we're going to build.

THERE ARE TWO WAYS TO COOK

Most people learn the first way and assume it's the only one. It's not.

PATH ONE

By recipe

You collect dishes you can repeat. Cooking takes hours of planning, and if you're missing an ingredient, you panic or order in. Other nights you open the fridge and assemble whatever's there, but it's never quite what you wanted. Forty dishes in, you're at the same level you started. Every meal is a fresh production.

PATH TWO · THE FOOD JAZZ WAY

By feel

You're in flow. You learn how flavors actually work: what fat does, what acid does, how heat changes texture. Walk into any kitchen, see what's there, make something. Missing an ingredient, you swap it. Stress-free, quick substitutions, every dish lands.

THREE THINGS THAT MIGHT HAVE BEEN IN YOUR WAY

- 1 You were taught there's a "right" way.** That if your bolognese isn't your grandmother's, it's wrong. There is no Platonic version of any dish. There's a hot pan, ingredients, and your sense of what tastes good. We start there.
- 2 You learned alone, in fragments.** Cookbooks, TikTok videos, a \$300 weekend dumpling class. Cooking has been taught in community for most of human history. A parent, a grandparent, a roommate, a coworker. That part isn't optional. It's how the skill actually transfers.
- 3 Your kitchen isn't built for you.** Most people have a kitchen stocked from forgotten experiments. A half jar of harissa, three different vinegars, a spice rack of one-recipe purchases. We're going to rebuild the whole setup around the food you actually want to eat.

*Because you have good taste,
and you deserve to eat well.*

The shape of the month.

A pre-week to observe how you actually eat, then four weeks built around heat: what's possible without it, what high heat does, what slow heat does, and how to put it all together. The shopping philosophy is simple. We buy the ingredients you already like eating, then spend the month combining and transforming them every way we can. The same handful of ingredients turns into four entirely different things depending on what you do to it. By the end, you're hosting a dinner party.

Pre-Week

OBSERVATION

You eat how you normally eat. Delivery, restaurants, what you reach for at night. Text me each day. Everything that comes next gets built around your taste, not around recipes. Even the grocery run starts looking the same every week, because you're shopping for what you actually like.

Week 1

MIXTURES

Cold food, no stove. Dressings, grain bowls, pickles, a full spice tasting session. We shop together and build your palate before anything gets hot.

Week 2

HIGH HEAT

Blazing cast iron, screaming wok, quick reflexes. High heat is the secret to a great meal in fifteen minutes after a workday. Things get hot and smoky.

Week 3

LOW & SLOW

Braising, baking, cooking for other people. You learn that patience is a technique, and that leftovers improve overnight.

Week 4

COMPOSITION

Full meals, not just dishes. You plan the plate, balance the table, execute it, and feed people. Your most independent week.

After

DINNER PARTY

You host. I show up as a guest. Your food, your people, no recipes in sight. This is what you've been building toward.

THE DAILY RHYTHM

The weekly sessions are where we cook together and the big lessons land. Between sessions, a small daily loop keeps you in motion.

MORNING

A prompt arrives in your texts.

YOUR DAY

Cook it. Note when you start and finish so you build a sense of flow. Send me a photo or quick video.

MY RESPONSE

Specific feedback within a few hours, voice memo or text. Not "looks great." Something you can use.

WEEKLY

In-person session at your place: we cook together, debrief the week, and I hand off reference materials as we go.

How to *show up*.

The whole month rests on a few small commitments. None of them are heavy on their own. Together they make the difference between a course you took and a habit you keep.

- 1 **Cook every day**, even when it's small, even when it's bad. Especially when it's bad. A meal that doesn't work teaches you more than one that does, because you actually have to figure out why.
- 2 **Set a timer when you start cooking**. Not to make you faster, just so you can see how fast you already are. Most weeknight meals take under twenty minutes once you stop second-guessing yourself. You'll be surprised.
- 3 **Check in every day**. A photo, a quick video, a voice note, or just a text. Whatever's easiest. This is how I track where you are and tailor what comes next. If I don't hear from you, I'll follow up. Consider yourself warned.
- 4 **Be honest**. If something tastes bad, say so. If you skipped a day, tell me. If you're confused, ask. There's no judgment here, ever.
- 5 **Let yourself be a beginner**. Cooking feels vulnerable. You're making something from scratch and asking someone to eat it. That's real. The only fix is doing it anyway, and you're going to do it a lot this month.



A marathon, not a sprint. Around day twelve or fifteen, this will stop feeling exciting and start feeling like routine. That isn't failure. That's where the real skill-building lives. Most people quit right there. Text me when it hits and we'll talk about it.



Happy little accidents. Some of what you make this month won't taste good. That's not failure, that's data. You learn more from a bad vinaigrette than a good one because you have to figure out what went wrong. I'll probably be eating it with you.

WHERE THIS LEAVES YOU

By day thirty, the way you think about food has shifted. Here's what tends to happen.

- You **open the fridge and see options**, not obstacles.
- You **taste mid-cook and know what's missing**. Too acidic, needs fat, almost there.
- You **shop for the week**, not for a recipe you'll make once and forget.
- You **cook for the people you love** without asking them to wait while you check your phone.

*Excited to see
the cook you become!*